



IT MANAGEMENT 2B

Total: 80 Marks

Duration: 2 Hours 30 Minutes

Semester Test 1

Student Number	Student Name and Surname

Instructions

- This paper consists of FOUR sections: A, B, C and D. Answer ALL questions in ALL sections.
- Number your answers clearly and correspond them to the question numbers below.
- No AI tools (ChatGPT, Copilot, Gemini, Claude or similar) may be used to generate answers unless explicitly permitted. Where used, disclosure is required as per the Academic Integrity Policy.
- Support your answers with reasoning and, where applicable, practical examples.
- You are only required to submit PDF files only.

SECTION A: CHANGE MANAGEMENT (25 Marks)

Scenario: Secure Cart Retail Group

Secure Cart Retail Group operates an online marketplace and 40 physical stores across South Africa. Following a data breach that exposed customer payment details, the board demanded an urgent overhaul of the company's IT systems.

Since the announcement, the Development team has pushed code updates directly to the production checkout system without any documented approval. The Network team, separately, replaced a core firewall over a weekend without informing the Service Desk, resulting in three hours of unexplained downtime the following Monday.

The CIO has appointed you as Change Management Process Owner and asked you to bring order to the current process.

- 1.1. Define Change Management and explain the difference between Change Control and Change Coordination. Use examples from the SecureCart scenario to support your answer. Your answer should include definition of Change Management, meaning of Change Control, meaning of Change Coordination, activities involved in each, one practical example. **[6 marks]**
- 1.1. Discuss the purpose of ITIL Change Management. Explain why Secure Cart should implement an effective Change Management process and describe any FIVE benefits it would provide. **[5 marks]**
- 1.2. Many organisations experience problems when implementing Change Management. Discuss any SEVEN common drawbacks of poor Change Management processes and explain how these drawbacks would affect Secure Cart. **[7 marks]**
- 1.3. Explain SEVEN of the thirteen steps required to design and implement an effective Change Management process at SecureCart. Briefly discuss the purpose of each step. **[7 marks]**

2. SECTION B: PROBLEM MANAGEMENT (21 Marks)

Scenario: Kaya Retail Point-of-Sale (POS) Failures

Kaya Retail operates 25 supermarkets. Over the past six weeks, tills in several stores have frozen every Friday and Saturday afternoon the busiest trading periods forcing staff to process sales manually on paper slips. Each time, the Service Desk logs a flood of calls, and the IT support technician on duty restarts the till servers, which restores service within 20–30 minutes.

Nobody has determined why the till servers repeatedly become unstable. The IT Support Manager now wants further investigation into the underlying cause to prevent the issue from happening again.

- 2.1. Explain whether the recurring till freezes should be treated as: Incidents, Problems, or Both. Justify your answer using the difference between Incident Management and Problem Management. **[4 marks]**
- 2.2. The Service Desk was the first point of contact for stores affected by this issue. Identify FOUR responsibilities the Service Desk should perform during an incident such as this one. For each responsibility, explain why it is important. **[4 marks]**
- 2.3. The IT team repeatedly restarted the till servers, but the underlying cause remained unknown. Explain why restarting the servers should be considered a temporary resolution rather than a permanent solution. Then identify THREE possible root causes that the Problem Management team could investigate. **[5 marks]**
- 2.4. Develop a logical sequence of steps that the IT department should follow from the moment the recurring till issue is identified until the problem is formally closed. Your process should include Identification, Recording, Investigation, Root-cause analysis, Resolution, Verification, Closure. You may add additional steps where appropriate. **[4 marks]**

- 2.5. You are the IT Manager. The IT Support Manager tells you: 'We have successfully resolved the freeze every time. There is no need to spend additional resources investigating it.' Would you agree or disagree? Provide a reasoned management response. Your answer must consider: Cost, Service availability, Repeated incidents, User impact, Business operations, Long-term risk. **[4 marks]**

3. SECTION C: BUSINESS CONTINUITY, DISASTER RECOVERY & FACILITIES MANAGEMENT (20 Marks)

Vukani Mining Ltd operates remote mine sites where connectivity is limited and power supply is unreliable. A single regional data centre supports payroll, safety-monitoring, and production-tracking systems for all sites.

- 3.1. Explain the concept of business continuity and discuss its importance in ensuring uninterrupted business operations at Vukani Mining. In your answer, describe how business continuity contributes to organisational resilience, service availability, customer confidence, and long-term business sustainability. Provide relevant examples to support your discussion. **[5 marks]**
- 3.2. Compare and contrast business continuity and disaster recovery. Discuss their objectives, scope, planning processes, implementation strategies, and how they complement each other during and after a disruptive event. Illustrate your answer with examples from Vukani Mining. **[5 marks]**
- 3.3. Critically discuss the role of a Business Impact Analysis (BIA) in business continuity planning at Vukani Mining. Explain how a BIA helps organisations identify critical business processes, assess operational risks, determine recovery priorities, estimate financial and operational impacts, and allocate resources effectively. **[5 marks]**
- 3.4. Discuss the responsibilities of executive management in the successful implementation of a business continuity programme at Vukani Mining. Explain why leadership commitment, funding, policy development, risk acceptance, organisational culture, and strategic decision-making are essential for business

continuity success. Also explain the responsibilities and competencies required of a Facilities Management Process Owner in supporting this programme. **[5 marks]**

4. SECTION D: CHANGE MANAGEMENT CASE STUDY (20 Marks)

Scenario: Litha Telecom

Litha Telecom is a South African telecommunications provider serving over 5 million customers through mobile, fibre, and business connectivity services.

The company has recently embarked on a Digital Transformation Programme including migrating customer databases to the cloud, deploying a new billing system, and replacing legacy network switching equipment. The executive committee approved the transformation after a series of network outages and rising customer complaints.

However: the Network Operations team wants to implement all upgrades immediately, the Information Security team insists that every change undergo extensive testing, some engineers have begun implementing changes without submitting formal change requests, different departments maintain separate spreadsheets to track changes, resulting in duplicated work, several emergency changes have been implemented without approval, communication between departments is poor, and a previous software update caused a national billing outage that left thousands of customers unable to top up or pay accounts.

The CEO appoints a new Executive Sponsor and a Change Management Process Owner to redesign the organisation's change management process using ITIL best practices.

- 4.1. As the newly appointed Process Owner, critically evaluate the current change management practices at Litha Telecom. Your answer should: identify at least FOUR weaknesses in the current process; explain how each weakness increases organisational risk; recommend appropriate improvements based on ITIL Change Management principles. Support your discussion with practical examples from the scenario. **[8 marks]**
- 4.2. Several departments have started making production changes without following formal approval procedures. Discuss the possible organisational consequences if this behaviour continues. Your discussion should include impacts on: Business operations; Customers; Information security; Regulatory compliance; Financial performance; Service availability. Provide suitable examples from the telecommunications environment. **[6 marks]**